

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF SAN FRANCISCO
UNIFIED FAMILY COURT

JANE DOE,
Petitioner

VS.

JOHN DOE,
Respondent

) Case Number: FDI-26-802519
)
) Hearing Date: April 21, 2026
)
) Hearing Time: 9:00 AM
)
) Department: 404
)
) Presiding: AI MORI
)
)

REQUEST FOR ORDER: REQUEST FOR PERMISSION FOR CONFIDENTIAL DISSOLUTION
FILING

TENTATIVE RULING

Having read and considered the pleadings, declarations, and other evidence submitted in this matter, the
Court makes the following findings and orders:

A. Procedural History

- 1) On 1/30/2026, Petitioner Jane Doe filed a Petition for Dissolution of Marriage against
Respondent John Doe. Petitioner states the parties married on 12/12/2014 and separated on
1/30/2025, for a marriage of 11 years and 1 month. The parties have 4 minor children, Children
Doe 1 – 4, ages ranging from 4 to 13. Both parties are self-represented.
- 2) On for hearing is Petitioner’s Request for Order filed 1/30/2026. Petitioner states Respondent is
her second husband. Petitioner states her first husband subjected her to extreme physical and
psychological violence and she has a permanent restraining order against her first husband.
Petitioner lodged documentary evidence to show that she is in California’s “Safe At Home
Address” program. Petitioner states her first husband has also threatened to harm Respondent and
their children and he has been able to find “us at various points through various ways.” Petitioner
asks the Court to:
 - a. Permit the parties to proceed in this action under pseudonyms;

- b. Order the parties' legal names and identifying information be sealed, redacted, or excluded from public records to the extent permitted by law; and
 - c. Grant any other relief the Court deems just and proper to protect their safety.
 - 3) Both parties appeared at the prior hearing date on 4/9/2026. The Court continued the hearing to 4/21/2026 on its own motion.

B. Findings and Order

- 1) The Court finds that Petitioner is a protected person under the address confidentiality program pursuant to Government Code 6205 et seq. As such, she is entitled to use a pseudonym in a civil proceeding under Code of Civil Procedure section 367.3. The Court similarly finds that maintaining confidentiality of Respondent and the names of the parties' children is essential for their safety as well as Petitioner's safety and this interest outweighs the constitutional right of access in this case.
- 2) The parties are entitled to exclude or redact from all pleadings and documents filed in the action to conceal identifying information (as that term is defined by Code of Civil Procedure section 367.3(a)(1)) of the parties and their children. All parties and their agents and attorneys shall use pseudonyms for the parties (i.e., Jane Doe, John Doe, and Children Doe 1 – 4) in all pleadings, discovery requests or discovery motion documents, and other documents filed or served in the action, and at hearings, trial, and other court proceedings that are open to the public. However, as set forth in Code of Civil Procedure section 367.3(B)(2)(b), "[a] party seeking discovery in which the true name of the protected person and identifying information must be divulged for the purposes of fair and reasonable discovery, may use the true name of the protected person and identifying information for purposes of that discovery. The discovery request and all information collected through the discovery process shall not be made public."
- 3) As set forth in Code of Civil Procedure section 367.3(b)(2)(C), "A party filing a pleading, discovery document, or other document in the action shall exclude or redact any identifying characteristics of the protected person from the pleading, discovery document, or other document, except for a confidential information form" which shall be filed with the Court and served upon all other parties "that includes the protected person's name and other identifying characteristics being excluded or redacted" and which the Court shall keep confidential.

- 1 4) As set forth in Code of Civil Procedure section 367.3(b)(2)(D), “Following final disposition of
2 the proceedings a party in possession of any pleading, discovery document, or other document
3 containing confidential information of the protected person obtained in the course of the action
4 shall treat the documents as a nonpublic consumer record in accordance with Section 1798.81 of
5 the Civil Code, subject to penalty for violations of that section.”
- 6 5) As set forth in Code of Civil Procedure section 367.3(b)(3), “The responsibility to exclude or
7 redact identifying characteristics of the protected person from documents filed with the court rests
8 solely with the parties and their attorneys.” The Court is not required “to review pleadings or
9 other papers for compliance.”
- 10 6) Intentional violations of these orders are subject to sanction.
- 11 7) The Court will prepare the Findings and Order After Hearing.